ABOUT THIS PIECE

Spotlight Betrayal

Katherine Conklin

WHAT IT IS

A script sample for a drama, with a logline and an opening scene. A shy transfer student's new relationship begins to strain her friendships.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

How the logline sets up the story and how the scenes build tension.

The work itself starts on the next page.

Spotlight Betrayal

A drama · Script sample · Katherine Conklin

Logline

A shy transfer student's whirlwind romance with a charming but controlling boyfriend begins to unravel her friendships, culminating in a public confrontation that exposes his lies and reaffirms her bond with her roommates.

The script

Opening scene

INT. SPRING HILL COLLEGE DORM ROOM - DAY

The room is filled with boxes as four new roommates settle in. Emily, Mia, Hannah, and Chloe each unpack their belongings, chatting excitedly. The mood is light and full of hope.

MIA (smirking as she hangs up posters)
"Well, this is it. Fresh start at Spring Hill, huh?"

EMILY (nervous but smiling)
"Yeah, I just hope I can survive the first week."

HANNAH (laughing, putting up a plant)
"Oh, we've got this. Besides, with us all sticking together, we're basically unstoppable."

CHLOE (joining in)
"As long as we don't get lost trying to find the cafeteria again."

The girls laugh together. There is an immediate bond forming. Emily seems a little shy but is clearly relieved to have found friends so quickly.

Scene 2: Emily meets Logan

EXT. SPRING HILL COLLEGE CAMPUS - LATER THAT WEEK

Emily is walking to class alone when she bumps into Logan, a charming student who immediately takes notice of her.

LOGAN (flashing a charming smile)
"Whoa, sorry! You okay?"

EMILY (awkwardly)
"Oh, no, I'm fine. Just trying to navigate this place."

LOGAN (extending a hand)
"I'm Logan. Let me guess, new transfer?"

EMILY (nodding, smiling shyly)
"Yeah, just moved in. I'm Emily."

LOGAN
"Well, welcome to Spring Hill. If you ever need a tour guide... I've got the inside scoop."

Emily blushes slightly as Logan continues to charm her. They part ways, but Emily glances back, intrigued.

Middle act: Logan's possessive behavior escalates

INT. DORM ROOM - NIGHT

Emily is texting Logan, who keeps asking her where she is and why she isn't spending time with him. Meanwhile, Mia, Hannah, and Chloe are having fun in the room, trying to get Emily to join them.

MIA (playfully)
"Hey, Emily, we're going out to the campus movie night. You in?"

EMILY (hesitant, looking at her phone)
"Um... I don't know. Logan was saying he wanted to hang out later."

HANNAH (rolling her eyes)
"Girl, you're always with Logan. Come on, you need a break."

EMILY (defensive, still texting)
"He just likes spending time with me. It's not a big deal."

CHLOE (gently)
"We just don't want you to lose yourself, you know? We miss hanging out with you."

Emily hesitates but ultimately decides to stay in and text Logan instead of joining her roommates. Mia, Hannah, and Chloe share concerned glances as they head out without her.

Midpoint: the concert build-up

EXT. CONCERT VENUE - NIGHT

Logan is preparing for a concert performance. He tells Emily not to come, claiming he is nervous and does not want to mess up in front of her.

LOGAN (looking stressed)
"Look, this performance means a lot to me. I don't want to screw up with you there watching."

EMILY (confused)
"But I've seen you perform before. Why would this be different?"

LOGAN (annoyed)
"I just don't need the pressure, okay? Just... don't come. It's better that way."

Emily, feeling hurt and confused, reluctantly agrees, but her roommates have other plans.

Climax: the public confrontation

INT. CONCERT VENUE - LATER THAT NIGHT

Emily's roommates drag her to the concert despite Logan's request. From the crowd, they see Logan flirting with another girl, who is wearing the same bracelet he gave Emily.

CHLOE (pointing)
"Is that... is she wearing your bracelet?"

MIA (narrowing her eyes)
"That's it. We're ending this tonight."

Emily, realizing the truth, storms onto the stage mid-performance. The music cuts as she grabs the mic.

EMILY (furiously)
"So this is why you didn't want me here? Flirting with her while I was at home like an idiot?"

LOGAN (stammering, caught off guard)
"Emily, wait, it's not what it looks like—"

EMILY (cutting him off, turning to the audience)
"You all want to hear the real show? How about a song about a guy who gives the same bracelet to two different girls?"

Mia, Hannah, and Chloe join her on stage, turning the confrontation into a public takedown. The crowd cheers as Logan runs off stage, humiliated.

Final scene: reconciliation and empowerment

INT. DORM ROOM - THE NEXT MORNING

Emily sits with Mia, Hannah, and Chloe, who comfort her after the intense night. There is a sense of relief and empowerment in the air.

EMILY (softly)
"I should've listened to you guys from the start."

MIA (smiling)
"We've got your back. Always."

EMILY (smiling for the first time)
"I'm so glad we became friends."

The girls share a warm moment, reaffirming their bond and the importance of their friendship.